

Top Three Open Source DATA BACKUP TOOLS

This article examines three open source data backup solutions that are the best among the many available.



Open source data backup software has become quite popular in recent times. One of the main reasons for this is that users have access to the code, which allows them to tweak the product. Open source tools are now being used in data centre environments because they are low cost and provide flexibility.

Let's take a look at three open source backup software packages that I consider the best. All three provide support for UNIX, Linux, Windows and Mac OS.

Amanda

This is one of the oldest open source backup software packages. It gets its name from the University of Maryland where it was originally conceived. Amanda stands for the Advanced Maryland Disk Archive.

Amanda is a scheduling, automation and tracking program wrapped around native backup tools like tar (for UNIX/Linux) and zip (for Windows). The database that tracks all backups allows you to restore any file from a previous version of that file that was backed up by Amanda. This reliance on native backup tools comes with advantages and disadvantages. The biggest advantage, of course, is that you will never have a problem reading an Amanda tape on any platform. The formats Amanda uses are easily available on any open-systems platform. The biggest disadvantage is that some of these tools have limitations (e.g., path length) and Amanda will inherit those limitations.

On another level, Amanda is a sophisticated program that has a number of enterprise-level features, like automatically determining when to run your full backups,